

I built Card Game 24 by taking on the role of an architect and product tester, guiding Claude step-by-step rather than asking it to generate everything in one go. We tackled the project in deliberate phases, first setting up a modular Python CLI version (`card24.py`), then porting the entire logic into a responsive, single-file web app (`index.html`). Whenever the AI hit a wall or took a shortcut, I stepped in to refine the approach. For instance, to avoid using unsafe `eval()` functions, I had the AI implement a custom recursive descent parser that safely validates user input. When testing tricky hands like `[3, 3, 8, 8]`, standard floating-point math kept giving rounding errors like `24.000000000000004`, so I pushed us to rebuild the evaluation engine around exact fraction arithmetic. On the front end, I caught a jarring UX issue where "unsolvable hand" alerts popped up before the card dealing animations even finished, so I had the AI tweak the event timing for a smoother feel. Treating the AI as an junior dev made me do more testing, code review, and user experience.

AI Chat link: <https://claude.ai/share/14da3456-7d21-450e-94de-aae19c7e8b92>